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The Impact of WeSolv Case Challenges on Candidates' Career Trajectories

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Executive Summary

Through the use of real projects, referred to as Case Challenges, WeSolv links businesses with a diverse network of MBAs. Candidates participate in Case Challenges to gain experience and demonstrate their skills, while companies can hire based on performance. It was uncertain whether Case Challenges impact candidates' career trajectories, so throughout our internship, we researched and analyzed data to determine if Case Challenges impact career trajectories. By recording each candidate's job title, company, and function prior to their MBA, after their MBA, and currently (July 2022) in a spreadsheet, we could then analyze if they pivoted to a new career/function due to participating in that Case Challenge. After completing the project, we realized that a majority of the individuals experienced at least one career pivot throughout the course of their MBA studies.

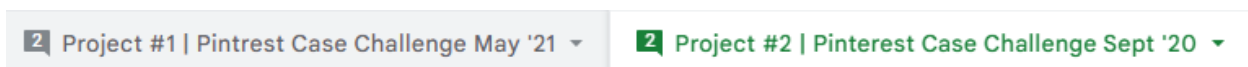
Business Context

An issue pressing companies today is hiring diverse teams. The traditional recruiting model of hiring candidates through resumes and interviews cannot show a candidate's true skills and talents. WeSolv brings together diverse candidates and top companies, and its mission is to provide opportunities for all candidates to demonstrate their skills. It is a crowdsourcing platform that allows candidates to complete real projects (Case Challenges) to find more qualified and diverse hires.

Career-switchers (those who are changing industries, roles, or come from non-traditional/linear business backgrounds) need to demonstrate their talent and skills through experiential learning opportunities such as WeSolv's Case Challenges. By participating in these Challenges, candidates can demonstrate their skills, and companies can recruit candidates based on performance.

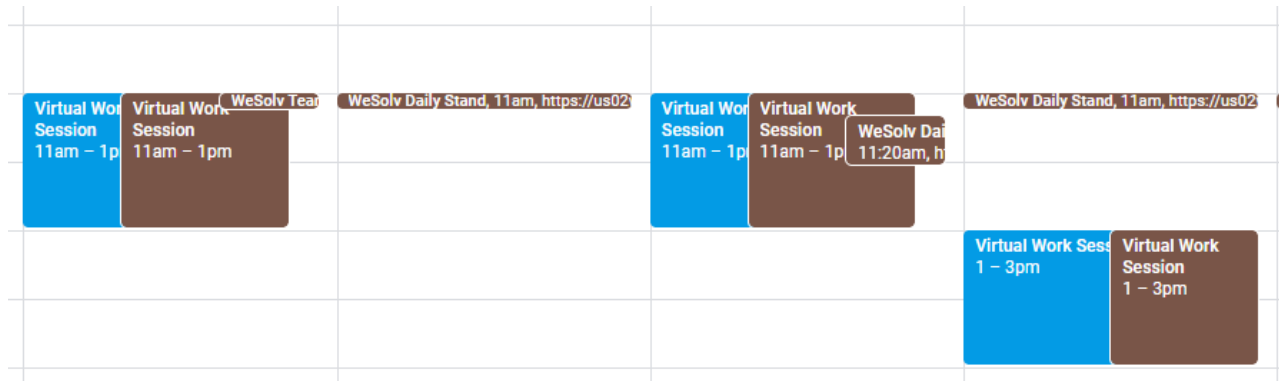
Business Project Description

The purpose of this project was to understand WeSolvers' (people who complete WeSolv Case Challenges) career paths to identify whether participating in a WeSolv Case Challenge had any impact on their career trajectories. The research conducted in this project will fill in the data gaps to understand where these MBA candidates were in their career paths prior to and after participating in the Challenge. Throughout the internship, instead of completing one large project, there were multiple smaller ones that mirrored this one for other Case Challenges and for the competitive landscape of WeSolv's product and solution offerings.



Screenshot of two projects for different Case Challenges.

While most of the work was done asynchronously, there were virtual work sessions.



Screenshot of the calendar for four days during our internship.

These virtual work sessions enabled us to have direct interaction with our mentors. It provided the opportunity for us to get to know each other and the company atmosphere better. Additionally, there were Daily Stands, which consisted of the entire team meeting in the morning for about 15 minutes. The 15 minutes was used to allow everyone to know who was working on what and goals for the day. These were effective because it allowed everyone to stay on track.

Business Project Research

The question intertwined throughout this project was: did participating in a WeSolv Challenge cause the candidate's career to continue under a new function? This research and data compilation is important for WeSolv to understand the impact of WeSolv's Case Challenges on current and recent MBA candidates' career trajectories.

To complete this project, we researched and recorded each candidate's job title, company, and function prior to their MBA, after their MBA, and currently (July 2022) in a spreadsheet. We primarily utilized LinkedIn and Google for this project. When using LinkedIn, we looked at the following features: education, experience, and companies. The Education feature would tell us about MBA start and end years, which signaled if we had the correct candidate's profile. The Experience feature contains information about work history, while company profile pages allow us to learn more about the industry. We used these two features to gather information about their job and function. Occasionally, we would not be able to find a certain candidate through LinkedIn's search feature, so we would use Google instead. By using both LinkedIn and Google, we were able to fill in almost all of the candidates' information.

We exercised our online research skills to learn more about specific MBA programs, companies, and functions to improve our accuracy. This expanded our knowledge of the business world, as we now have a better understanding of various companies, functions, and jobs. For example, we realized that many individuals worked in occupations with different functions, such as research, marketing, and management, over the past couple of years. Career pivoting is a phenomenon that occurs a lot more frequently than we expected. This project taught us firsthand that you do not have to stay with the same function forever. People frequently change careers for the betterment of their future, and career pivoting is not an abnormality.

Business Project Key Learnings & Recommendations

After completing these projects, our key takeaways was that companies such as WeSolv take importance in analyzing data and trajectories that many people do not realize is important. Our experience in analyzing how people changed their course of careers after attending a case challenge made us realize the impact that WeSolv has made in peoples occupational life.

More key takeaways include knowledge and increased familiarity with various functions, jobs, and companies. When we assigned a function to the job on the spreadsheet, there were around 25 functions that we chose from, such as marketing, data analysis, and product management. A challenge we encountered was having difficulty distinguishing between the various functions. In the beginning, we were not too familiar with these functions or job titles, so it was hard to match them. For example, a sales manager was actually under the function of sales and not management. Nonetheless, we were able to conquer this problem through discussions with our mentors. A small note would be to provide opportunities for us to understand the various functions before needing to use them in a project, because it will make the process less confusing.

Our internship with WeSolv was a pleasant one as we gained experience in the real business world. However, there were times where we spent time reviewing work we completed, as we finished early and there was no new task assigned. This is likely due to WeSolv being an early start-up and a little short-staffed. However, it would be incredibly hard to avoid these challenges, as one mentor moved to a different job and another recovered from COVID.

Annotated Bibliography

Afrotech. AfroTech. (n.d.). Retrieved July 19, 2022, from <https://afrotech.com/>

AfroTech is a large series of multicultural tech experiences, ranging from engineers to recruiters. They host the AFROTECH Conference, one of the largest Black tech conferences in the United States. During this Conference, people can connect with over 20,000 Black tech innovators. Just like AfroTech, WeSolv also supports BIPOC (Black, Indigenous, and people of color) by providing diverse candidates a platform and opportunity.

Empowering visionaries. NBMBAA. (n.d.). Retrieved July 19, 2022, from <https://nbmbaa.org/>

The National Black MBA Association helps underrepresented candidates throughout their careers by giving educational, wealth building, and growth opportunities. Their goal is similar to WeSolv's, and both share similar target audiences: diverse candidates. By learning more about WeSolv-adjacent companies, it allows a better understanding of the importance of diversity and opportunities.

Home. Relish. (n.d.). Retrieved July 19, 2022, from <https://www.relishcareers.com/>

Relish helps diverse candidates, such as employers, job candidates, and universities with the career search and job process. They expanded from their original target audience, MBA candidates, to students, schools, and companies over time. Similarly, WeSolv's current target audience is MBA candidates, but over time, that will change as WeSolv expands.

More women leading. Forte Foundation. (n.d.). Retrieved July 19, 2022, from <http://www.fortefoundation.org/site/PageServer>

Forté's mission is to help women launch into meaningful careers by providing access to business education and a community of successful women. Forté is another one of WeSolv's adjacent companies that has a different target audience, women, but they both work towards the same goal: providing opportunities to diverse candidates.

Our story. Management Leadership for Tomorrow. (n.d.). Retrieved July 19, 2022, from <https://mlt.org/>

MLT's goal is to build diverse leaders and equitable work spaces. They provide opportunities to underrepresented groups to push for their goal. By gaining knowledge of organizations adjacent to WeSolv, more is known about the community, and services offered to them can be tailored.

Appendices

✓ Data Analysis - Career Switchers	◀ WeSolver Career Histr	2	🗨
✓ WeSolver Career Histories Research Project		2	🗨 1 📄
✓ Asana Content Marketing Communications Tracker			
✓ CRM: Hubspot			
✓ Marketing Resources and Tools Folder			
✓ WeSolv Business Roadmap			
✓ WeSolv Applications			
✓ Team		9	📄
✓ WeSolv Mission, Vision, & Values			
✓ WeSolv Messaging Guide			
✓ Creating Company Accounts			
✓ WeSolv File Management		1	📄
✓ WeSolv Agreements/ Code of Conduct			
✓ Familiarize yourself with WeSolv-adjacent organizations		1	🗨 ⬆ ⬆ Details >
✓ Company User Experience			
✓ Candidate User Experience		1	🗨 1 📄

Tasks we completed over the course of this internship.